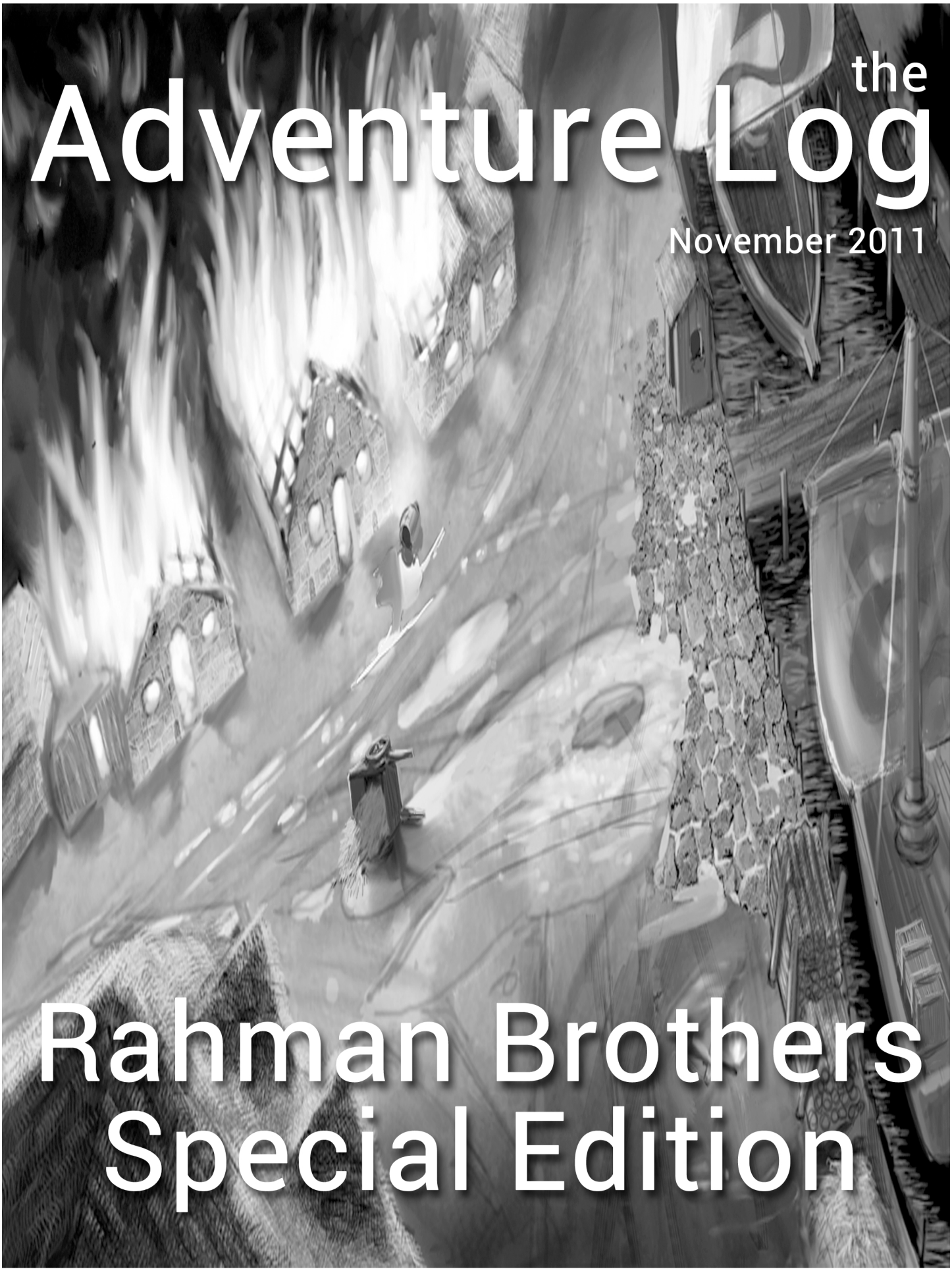


# the Adventure Log

November 2011

# Rahman Brothers Special Edition

# The Adventure Log

• Special Rahman Brothers Edition •

**November 2011**

We started the campaign in the spring of 2009. As conceived, it was a one shot session. I designed it for newbies and friends, as an introduction to D&D and our games, much like the *Keep on the Borderlands* session we'd run a few months before that. A game with civilized people. The adventure was supposed to be a simple affair: the players survive an attack by some brigands and then race to pillage a tomb before their rivals manage to clean it out. What resulted was somewhat different. A village burned, paladins and clerics got savaged and the world was introduced to the Rahman Brothers.

It's been two (and a half) years now. In the beginning we played over speakerphone. Then Skype.

I thought it was high time to celebrate the glorious brilliance of the Rahman Brothers. I've included a campaign summary and thrown in some bits from the newly completed Field Guide to the Lowlands. There's also a draft of the new magic rules from the upcoming Stabmaster 8: Blood Market rules.

**Contents**:


Rahman Brothers: The Whole Bloody Affair

Draft of the Stabmaster 8 Magic Rules

Borderlands of Wallendahr

The Field Guide to the Lowlands: Excerpts

- Tavern Tales (and slang)
- Gods & Religions
- No Adventure is Complete Without A Good Pint (and tobacco)
- A Quick Glossary of Magical Herbs
- Common Magic Items


Although there's no reason to expect the Brothers to survive another session, they somehow manage. It's part of their understated genius. No one could possibly predict their next actions if they don't know themselves. Made all the more entertaining by the long hours spent planning and strategizing, invariably forgotten as soon as they actually do anything. I look forward to the future where Lark-Han is on fire, Zhan has invaded Vijmania and there's a Rahman Selling Cloth in every town.

# The Rahman Brothers: The Whole Bloody Affair

*The Rahman Brothers. What started as a simple dungeon crawl one-off degenerated into an excellent anti-heroic fantasy campaign of the first water. The "whole bloody affair" starts with my original summary then pulls the session summaries chronologically after that through October 21, 2011.*

**Autumn 41 to Autumn 52, 3117n**

Abas and his brother Uzi left their home town of Bitoni and sailed for Sadon to conquer the world. Or re-conquer, since it was rightfully theirs already.

(Autumn 41) They joined a caravan heading west towards Lark-Han which was promptly ambushed by Mad Lucifer's Men. Wandering around in the aftermath they joined up with Iron Cobb just long enough to find out about a tomb on the cliffs not too far off. They attacked Cobb and took him back into Esteron unconscious, handing him over to the locals once he was recognized [thanks for clarifying that, Alex].

With Esteron in flames behind them they made for the tomb, looting it and killing off the Sons of Freedom in the process.

(Autumn 46) A few shepherds and fellow caravan survivors later, Abas brought his near-dead brother into the town of Linley, where he was promptly killed. A few dead people later Abas made his way back to Sadon where Fahqu, the next Rahman brother, was due to arrive.

> **Alex on fleeing Linley after Uzi's death**:
> "Well, if I remember correctly, after I slaughtered the Tala priestess for accidentally killing my brother, I needed a way out of there. So I grabbed the nearest thing I could find (little old lady praying in the temple), and used her as a hostage/human shield to get me out of the temple and to my (formerly Uzi's) war horse. I then mounted the horse and dragged the little old lady by the hair as I galloped out of town. I tried to throw her at some little kid who was standing by the town gate as I rode by, but I missed him and she instead flew face first into a wall at about 30 mph."

Fahqu and Abas set up shop (Rahman Selling Cloth), bought a war chariot and made for Linley to exact some additional revenge. They followed a group of Talan priests from Linley to Bagtran and, well, the village burned and a lot of people died (Autumn 50).

They encountered Jir-Marat outside of town who made a lot of vague promises before leaving them with a sickly crow. On Marat's suggestion they made their way south. Some orcs died, along with some guy who tried to steal one of their horses.

They found themselves at Pitus Farm the next day. A lot of farmers died. And things got strange inside the farm compound.

Which brings us to **Autumn 52**, a damp and drizzling day in the Lowlands of Zhan outside of Pitus Farm.

**A few missing events between the summary above and the new logged summaries below:**

The brothers make their way to Ahns Barrot, deliver a few captives to the temple, and leave on their way to break Myrtle's curse. Get jumped by Thanes Bane, a bunch of dwarven fortune hunters, and after some killing wind up back in Ahns Barrot for some rest and recovery.

**Autumn 56 to 58, 3117n Session: August 3, 2009**

The Rahman brothers set out (again) from Ahns Barrot on their way to Farngard. The objective: grab one of Teserius' apprentices and deliver him to the witch Myrtle. On the way they ran into the hill giant Goddam.

Losses: 1 slave, 1 henchman, 2 horses, 1 expensive axe, 12 hours of desperately needed time.

The brothers made short work of an ambush by the Wereweasels. It turned out their latest hire, Torris, was an inside man. They discovered a bounty was on their heads for "crimes against the Kingdom", which seemed like a bland accusation considering all they'd done.

By the end of the session the brothers arrived in Farngard to find Teserius gone, the apprentices drunk, and things looking way too easy.

**Autumn 58 to 60, 3117n Session: August 19, 2009**

Fahqu stabbed one of the apprentices in the finger with a fork, enough to spill blood on the floor. This unleashed a demon, summoned the witch Myrtle and got the attention of the mage Teserius. A short and predictably bloody fight later and Abas made his escape, one bound apprentice and an unconscious Fahqu in tow. And a burning farm behind.

Tori, the lone surviving henchman, seized the moment and attacked Abas. A few blows later left him dead on the ground, and Abas rifled through the Burlap Sack of Holding in an effort to revive his brother.

They delivered the apprentice to the witch and camped in what amounted to a well-traveled crossroads, woken up by travelers and attacked by goblins. Heading southwest as they followed a map they'd looted from the Thanes Bane dwarves, they found themselves outside of Bagtran once again.

A few murders, a new pet and one unsettling shepherd later found the brothers in Tynine, a small town to the west, where Fahqu's astounding constitution won them healing and free rooms from the local Sylas cult. They also found a new henchman, a sickly ginger named Dung.

**Autumn 61 to 62, 3117n Session: September 2, 2009**

A fine morning in the country town of Tynine found the Rahman brothers in the Trollop Inn. Joined by the halfling Hanson the brothers went shopping at Old Ed's, netting five new recruits and making a big boy out of Dung. And the dog.

Back at the inn the brothers made a deal with some dwarves to ride with their caravan to Battis via Tarlahan.

Chaos returned as a roving orc warband threatened the outlying farms. The town's temple managed to erupt in flames, Hanson fled, Bessy died, something really bad happened to a lot of old women and children, and the brothers rode out of town with some priestesses.

By nightfall they found themselves near an old Lowlander town called Firdus and settled in for some rest. Firdus, it turns out, is a hive of werewolves. A few improvised weapons later and half the inn was in ruins, the huge werewolf called Grunge was nowhere to be found and Jir-Marat materialized and helped cover their escape.

Tammie was missing, the priestesses were dead, but the brothers did have three werewolf bodies to show for the trouble. And two of them still had heads.

**Autumn 62 to 64, 3117n Session: December 4, 2009**

Joined by Merik Long Hands the brothers run into the Herdsmen, who suggest joining forces on their way to plunder the tomb of an ancient Araketi witch named Nepatiri. The Herdsman, just two elves and a halfling after a run-in with werewolves, tell them the tomb is under a dolmen in the Black Moors. A fight ensues and the Herdsmen are killed. Fahqu, Sara and Merik are grievously wounded, and Abas yet again takes an unconscious brother off to get healed.

Traveling east along the old Tarlahan road towards Waloche (pronounced "waylock", the closest settlement they haven't set fire to), the group passes an old healing woman among some Malauri. Thinking they are soldiers returning from the wars against the "evil Vijmans", she brings the wounded back to consciousness for a handful of gold.

Newly revived, the brothers continue east to Waloche. Within site of the city they happen on Ballastrad the Great, a fellow Vijmanian trader of House Porris who has sold off his Lowland holdings and loaded everything into his giant slave powered carriage, a massive rolling house complete with sails. Sara gets crushed under one of the wheels. The brothers join Ballastrad, reversing course as they head west towards Tarlahan (and then onto Battis). A long night of revelry ends in bloodshed as Ballastrad gets killed, his dancing girls strangled and all 50 slaves slaughtered. Miraculously his mercenary troops survive and join forces with the brothers. They pillage the carriage but aren't able to extricate the treasure from its magical vault.

The brothers, now teamed with Hassan and his soldiers, ride hard through the next day and night to reach Tarlahan. Holed up in a dive in the slums called the Horny Nymph, the brothers regroup and wait to find out how much trouble killing a guild-protected merchant will bring them, as well as the inevitable revenge of the Porris family.

As of now the inn has not burned down.

**Autumn 65 to 66, 3117n Session: January 22, 2010**

30 hours in Tarlahan and more than fifty people dead, two guilds angered and one inn burnt to the ground. But ultimately this day and half in the city is a love story.

It began as the brothers arrived and set up in the third floor of the Horny Nymph in the dodgy neighborhood of the Docks. Hassan rounded up a Senguerian priestess to heal the brothers and identify their recently looted magic, but on the way some thugs mistook the brothers for plump tourists. Some killing happened. Then the brothers met two men posing as famous adventurers who offered them a job looting a temple.

Led by their newly hired man Maggot, they wound their way to Arad, a Vijmani immigrant neighborhood and home to the local mob run by the Kaht family. They paid for the most beautiful woman their money could buy (or rather that Ballastrad's money could buy) and found themselves across the street in a brothel. And this is where it all begins, as Fahqu set eyes on Naqbled.

Meanwhile, it turns out the Kaht family is particularly close to the Porris family, and many questions were being asked. Like "why was Fahqu wearing Ballastrad's clothes?".

Foiled in his efforts to buy Naqbled from the brothel, the brothers made it back to the Nymph only to find an irate pimp named Chiffon trying to kill them.

As Fahqu pined for Naqbled, Abas set up a meeting with a dwarf named Pitule of the Stone guild to buy peace with Chiffon and his band of adolescent thugs. Pitule brokered the peace and even agreed to snatch Naqbled from the Kaht family in return for 2,000 gold. As he left the brothers set out to find the 1,600 gold they still owed him.

Many ideas later the brothers raided the inn where the two con men they'd met were staying, hoping to net the needed money. By then they'd decided to just kill Pitule and not give him the money, but that didn't stop them from slaughtering everyone in the Bloated Gopher and burning it to the ground. They netted about 70gp. Abas did, however, stumble on a ring of invisibility. The final blow to the Gopher came from a fireball that took out the bar, the surviving patrons, Dung, Olivia, and Abas' dog Death.

At dawn of the 66th the brothers killed Pitule as he delivered Naqbled. Love, like all good things, can sour over time. Fahqu led her up to the room to kill her, but on the way ran into the town guard.

The morning found Fahqu and Naqbled in the Purtley constabulary, Hassan's soldiers hoofing it to Battis, Merik missing and Abas outside the building with what was left of their gang.

**Autumn 66 to 67, 3117n Session: March 28, 2010**

The Third Full began with a drizzling rain, wanted posters for the brothers and Hassan, Fahqu and Naqbled in custody and Merik on death row. All within 30 feet of each other.

The judge told Fahqu to get out of town. On the way they made a half-hearted attempt to rob the temple of Roan, which turned into an earnest effort to rob the entire Rayik compound. Abas made his escape through the priceless stained glass of the rectory and the brothers eventually left the city for Battis, leaving behind Merik and Uzi's horse in the process.

Along the way a few people died, the brothers bought themselves an oddity in the form of Edna, and they ran across Darintor the Great, Purveyor of Exotic Slaves. They hit it off with the fellow Vijmanian, setting up a future meeting in Lanion.

Late on the 67th they approached Battis and discussed the best approach for a bunch of wanted men.

**Autumn 68 to 69, 3117n Session: July 12, 2010**

The brothers headed south towards an out-of-the-way town called Markil as they planned their route into Battis. They fought off an attack from the mage Teserius' thugs and made camp with an elf whose partner had recently died. They avoided what may have been werewolves and then found themselves in Markil.

They paid for their stay with an avant-garde performance and the next morning started to head out, but on discovering a beautiful girl named Violet they realized they couldn't leave without her. Plans went awry and some farmers died, they kidnapped the local priest and stole a horse. They also gained a follower, Gums, an old man who'd dreamed of being an adventurer. Determined to have Violet, they sent in an old woman to arrange a secret meeting in the abandoned mill outside of town.

The mill, as it turns out, is an excellent place to get ambushed. As it ignited into flames the brothers and their gang made a wild charge through the ring of archers. It's as though the whole town was there, and all of them excellent shots. Their captive priest died in the chaos, Edna, Gums and the elf were lost, and the love story of Naqbled and Faqhu met a sad end as she slumped off the horse and landed poorly.

The night ended with the brothers on the road, a cold night of drizzling rain, Nancy and Hassan wounded and unconscious.

**Autumn 70 to 72, 3117n Session: July 30, 2010**

Markil behind them, the brothers rode to the fishing village of Gordal and stayed the night. They opted against crossing the river and made their way into Battis from the Lowlands, through the dwarven fortress of Moor-Han.

Once in Battis they recruited a few Meledian priests and found the vaults at Larson & Bowman where they used their stolen key to empty vault 1359. They also discovered the heads of Hassan's men on spikes outside of House Porris in Aklan. They took a room nearby at the Black King, revenge brewed and betrayal was narrowly avoided as Tirim, one of the priests, thought about ratting them out.

Revenge was served up in a lively fashion the next morning. Tirim died, some vengeance on House Porris and House Kaht as each lost a family member, with a confusing trail of clues behind for the families to decipher. The brothers fled the crime scene toward the River's Hole to meet up with the rest of the gang, city watch and guild thugs fast behind them.

**Autumn 72 to 73, 3117n Session: August 31, 2010**

A cold drizzle outside as the brothers met up with the rest of the gang at the River's Hole in the Wash. Plans were discussed, alarm bells and shouts were getting closer outside as news of grizzly murders swept the city.

There weren't many people in the bar that morning, and none of them made it out alive. Except for Masarood, a Shadisi traveler who made off with all of the Rahman's newfound gold. More plans for revenge were added to the list.

The gang staged the butchery at the bar, framing the hapless adventurer Jonny Doom and going so far as to dress him in their clothes (and Fahqu's helmet) in hopes of his getting the noose for all of their crimes.

Following their only lead in pursuit of Masarood, they made their way to Fishhead and the dive bar Blue Mage. They joined forces with the Ticks, a neighborhood gang just as the whole place went up in flames. Fleeing pursuit they found the sewers, killed some tobacconists, stole a hay cart and headed to the next Blue location, the Bluebeard Inn in Barsapan.

It was Abas's turn to fall in love, marrying a Shadisi girl in a midnight ceremony. Her brothers were recruited to the band and inquiries into Masarood's whereabouts began to pay off. Plans were hatched. Marriages were consummated.

**Autumn 74 to 75, 3117n Session: September 29, 2010**

[a rough summary...]

Following the wedding the brothers hatched plans: how do they get rich? How do they burn down Markil? How to they get out of the city?

Hatching plans in the room, trying to figure out an escape, talking to Kihm about layout, get Porris thugs Garrig and Tamiq to join them along with the Palace girls, stumble on Kaht guilders trying to get rid of mage body (demon issue), kill them, make a getaway out the back in three groups.

Fahqu sidetracked at bar, Ticks run afoul of Pigs and rising guild efforts to find them, Abas skims some Pigs, most of them make it out the "Camel's Ass" gate, into the countryside going upriver, maybe Ferry of the Damned, maybe brigand village/holdout.

Purchase some special kids in city from Porris pimp/guild-guy (Garrig). Ended up sending Palace girls home/on their way.

Stomp on Garrig's head (Porris pimp/guild-guy) while he's sleeping, do poor job of hiding body, manage to retain his guy Mariq. Jir Marat appears, invites them to bring the special children to Ahns Barrot.

> [**corrections**...
>
> Alex: Don't think we actually killed pimp. Think we just stomped his head, stuffed him behind some rocks, and went on our way. But he was alive when we left him. Maybe the buzzards got him, though. Damned buzzards.
>
> Me: I think you're right, just left for dead. Didn't you guys say "he must have left" but then the npcs looked around and found him, like 10 feet away behind a rock?
>
> Alex: Funny. Yeah, I'd forgotten about that. I think we then convinced them that brigands must have done it. And that he was dead. Awesome]

**Autumn 75 to 76, 3117n Session: October 27, 2010**

The brothers made for the bandit town they'd been told about, hoping to cross the river there and make for Markil. Revenge was in order. And a girl was involved. The cold wet crags of the Long Pox erupted into a fury of battle as they walked into an ambush. Paralyzed from a poisoned dart, Abas watched his brother make quick work of the Kaht thugs sent to kill them.

Twenty horses and a new recruit later the brothers continued on. Razill the Butcher (one of Kihm's brothers) built a 'Rahman Selling Cloth' sign out of limbs for the cart, which was also adorned with the torsos of the Kaht thugs.

Late that night they arrived at Kalipet, camp of the bandit lord Grendal the Beautiful. A few items/people/children got fed to the catapult. Deals were made. Ordol was rescued from the Woman Pit.

Tamiq lost his armor and boots at dice. In the morning the brothers crossed the river, joined by two of Grendal's men, but the boat never returned with their horses or newly rescued (purchased) women. Ordol, however, was sent back to them via the catapult.

By mid day the brothers were within sight of Markil, the sun was beginning to shine and things were looking up. Revenge was near.

**Autumn 76 to 77, 3117n Session: November 21, 2010**

When the brothers reached Markil it was a sleepy village enjoying a sunny day in late fall. When they left it was on fire. Over fifty people died, most of them children and elderly, and the whole affair is best described as "a horrible misunderstanding."

Satisfied that revenge had been served, the brothers left Markil on the southern road, following the treasure map they'd found weeks earlier on the bodies of the members of Thane's Bane. The brothers had lost some of their gang, but they had the village girl Violet and a few horses, along with Old Jane and Ox's doll. And they rescued Rumpo, the elf they'd misplaced when they were last in town. Iyit died, killed by Razill for pushing his brother to his death, and the tale of the Ticks ended with Milit and Tahik crushed under the town's portcullis. Kimmy and Andahaine (last of the Ticks) died in the fighting, and Nancy and Kihm were captured but later rescued. Edna, who was hanging in a cage outside the gates, was left there. Shahaz went missing. The children were left in the care of the villagers, who were in sudden sore need of a younger generation anyway.

Many miles later, harassed by orcs, the brothers and their band fought their way into the tiny hamlet of Cressy for a night's rest. Ox was found dead in the morning, his throat cut, but otherwise the hospitality of the town was surprisingly good. And though the village had gotten word that Markil was attacked, the armed group coming from that direction didn't seem to concern them.

**Autumn 77 to 79, 3117n Session: December 17, 2010**

Declining the invitation to stay for High Hog Day, the Brothers decided to leave Cressy on the cold sleeting morning of the 77th. The decision didn't sit well with the villagers. Old Jane died, Ox's child-doll 'Dox' fell in a well, and the town was on fire. The Brothers returned to consecrate the altar, albeit to a different god. Some sacrifices took place. Rumpo was one of them. They rescued two villagers, Chlo and Bob, and took them with them.

The Brothers made their way towards the Hammer Flats and the Tesladain Carnak. They met Sir Hadrain and his men, netting some fine armor, horses and a tent, where they spent the night. At the Snake Gorge they got one of Gremere's kobold gang to lead them to the Gorge Witch. They gave her Sir Hadrain in return for passage over the gorge.

By noon of the following day they arrived at the Tesladain Carnak on the Hurgon Plains, discovering that the dwarven tower of Petark Darren stood on top of it.

**A few comments**

Alex: Or maybe, "The Brothers, rectifying an ancient injustice, reconsecrated the altar to its rightful god, Thar-Emykl. Some nominal sacrifice was required. Rumpo the Elf graciously submitted himself for consideration, and was subsequently accepted for sacrifice. Though Thar-Emykl's standards have dropped significantly, Sylas was a liberal hippy, so reconsecration to Thar was necessary and the better of one evil."

Corbin: I contend that the paladin's spidey-sense was totally off. I have yet to do anything "evil" that wasn't forced. Did I want to smash kids on an altar? Was that my objective when I woke up that morning? No, no it wasn't. We were once again pawns in a sick twisted land where survival has to come first. And yes, hot chicks help us get thru these tough times. Uhh ugly ones do too. There's too many f-wads that keep trying to slow us down from our humble goal of setting up a business. They who cast stones like that bitch paladin need a reality check, not the Rahmans. Now --- to all - return our carts, chariots, shoo-shoo, lost gold and we promise to try harder.

Alex: Exactly. Although the Paladin dude was funny. Especially when the kobold was having his way with him. Speaking of which, how did that kobold manage to survive? His odds of living had to be about 15,000,000:1

**Autumn 79 to 80, 3117n Session: January 17, 2011**

The Tesladain Carnak was crawling with dwarves. Abas chipped a piece of the ancient petrified ruins of the Great Tree, then trot-charged the tower before the brothers veered off towards the dust of a caravan in the distance.

Like the Carnak, the caravan was crawling with dwarves. Far from the lush exotic merchant-train they'd expected, it was a military baggage train carrying troops and humanitarian relief to the front. Posing as Sir Hadrain the brothers and their entourage tagged along, gathering information from the scouts on the lay of the land and the location of the Ordeal of Fire.

The caravan stopped at the Slough, a refugee pit for Vijmanians fleeing the wars across the river in the Aradian Plains. The brothers made quick work of it, setting up a brothel/recruitment center and loading up with fresh faces. Sir Hadrain's name was sullied, a lot of refugees died, and by dawn the brothers were making a hasty exit across the Hammer Flats, their new hires in tow. Sick Guy was dragged off by wild dogs and a griffon plucked up Old Woman.

From the tar pits they found their way to a ravine. A careful inspection of one of the ravine walls led to a rockslide, knocking several of the new recruits out. An impromptu wedding was held for Fahqu and Ashley Whore and Chlo. Sir Hadrain officiated. Ilar made a great flower girl despite being unconscious.

The brothers took a few of the recruits into a cave, looking for the entrance to the tomb. Things didn't go well. A new plan was made. Tet was left to guard the horses along with the growing list of wounded: Brin, Ilar, Bubba, Farcus, Clerk, Carpenter and Bob.

The brothers made their way through some traps, some pits, some goblins and a chasm. A goblin cub almost bit off Fahqu's finger.

At last, confronted with the taunts of Jir-Brazmoron, the brothers discovered the Ordeal of Fire. The Ordeal consumed Nancy and Hassan. The brothers killed Razill, Tamiq, Haktis, Tim, Barsh and Noggin. Ashley and Chlo were missing. And Kihm died. It might be argued that since the only action Tim, Barsh and Noggin saw was fighting the brothers, the brothers more or less hired, fed and equipped their own opponents.

The brothers' band was 23 strong when it left the Slough. At the end of the day there were only the brothers. Demoralized, they left the Ordeal and found themselves somewhere in the middle of the Hammer Flats.

**Autumn 80 to 81, 3117n Session: January 31, 2011**

Abas and Fahqu decided to return to the caves and rescue Fahqu's wives. Battered and injured, they made their way south in a best guess as to the cave's location. Abas showed signs of the 'Slough Sickness'. They joined up with a handful of refugees running from wyverns. A small band of kobolds took out Fahqu and most of the refugees, and Abas dragged his unconscious brother along until he happened on a Malauri camp. The old woman there, Magaris, brought Fahqu back from the brink and told the brothers where they could find the tar pits near the caves.

They found chunks of horses and henchmen outside the caves, and inside there were orcs and more bodies. Ilar was alive, strapped to an altar with the orcs, but there was no sign of Violent or Chlo. Some orcs died. They left Ilar and the remaining orcs behind and headed back west thinking that was where the wives would be heading if they'd escaped.

They commandeered a cart and made their way through some army camps, heard rumors of towns being burned by Vijmanian raiders and orcs spilling over from the Red War, and the pending arrival of Harasdain Sevenfold, the dwarven hero. Late that night they made their way into the Free Company camp along the river known as "Camp One".

**Autumn 81 to 84, 3117n Session: February 19, 2011**

Camp One was a boon for the Brothers despite the mud, urine, vomit, filth, a demon-succubus-woman, a belligerent knight and many fools. They gathered new followers, healed up, cleaned up and even identified most of their pile of loot. Tiden, a former Cobra henchman, told them more about the Ordeal of Fire and the Pragot Caves, including a possible lead on the Wives. They learned that the Shindigs were in Torignan, Masarood was recently in Petek and no amount of scrying seemed to unearth the Wives or Shahaz. They also pondered the whereabouts and value of the so-called Scepter of Kings mentioned on their map.

They set out on the 83rd, following the river upstream to the south to skirt the Hammer Flats. They were short a few horses but their party now included a friar, a tracker and a thief, along with two women they bought/liberated. Other than the first (short-lived) man Palls, most of their new recruits seemed competent and things were looking up.

Tiden scouted the area near the caves, long swathes of the land, searching for any sign of the Wives. They made their way inside, continuing the search, past the remaining orcs and into the tunnel of the demon-headed idol's throat.

The passage emerged into a small network of caves, where they found some of the loot from their last band of followers, and mixed signs of the Wives. The caves opened (implausibly) into high mountains covered in a fresh snow. They first followed the tracks of some huge bear-footed beast up the mountainside, then thought better of it and followed a few orc tracks down the mountainside. They fought off three oversized wolfish animals as the sun began to set ahead of them on the 84th.

**Autumn 84 to 85, 3117n Session: March 19, 2011**

A few conflicting decisions later the brothers made their way down the slope, following the pair of orc tracks. A light snow began to fall as they found some gnoll tracks, then the dead orcs who had been making the first tracks. Undeterred, the brothers went straight down the mountain until they spotted a distant plume of smoke from an orc warren.

There was a lot of fighting and some poorly conceived strategies. Abas fell on his head and caught fire. The orcs bartered for a truce and gave the brothers one of their prisoners. She died horribly. They did, however, rescue her father (Henril) who led them down the mountain to the ancient town of Tapik. And they discovered the Scepter of Kings at the heart of the orc warren.

Tapik had a mystical past and Abas, who was slowly bonding with the scepter, began to see reflections of its former self echoed in the Second World. He found an ancient chamber at the heart of the town and inserted the scepter. Not much seemed to happen but afterward the crystal of the scepter started to pulse to the beat of his heart.

Still no sign of the Wives.

The locals urged the brothers to help them kill a beast that had been biting the heads off people and they begrudgingly set out to find it. Led by a local hunter (Urul) they made their way back up the mountain until they found the beast's cave. Apparently the same beast whose tracks they had found outside the first orc cave. A short fight later and they spotted Chlo high in the chimney of caves above. She stabbed Garnet in the eye, but otherwise a happy reunion was had including a feverish and sick Violent.

Friar Sweeney healed the girls, along with Garnet's face. The brothers had found the Wives and had yet another group assembled including Tiden, the ranger and former Cobra, and Bassy, the prostitute from Camp One.

**Autumn 85 to Winter 23, 3117n Session: April 23, 2011**

The brothers tied up the beast and looted the caves. On the way out the long years of bones rose up and formed mismatched skeletons, easily dispatched once the brothers realized they wouldn't enter the cave itself.

Stepping outside took the brothers to another realm, a pocket of the Second World. In this place Abas was the Lost King, Fahqu was a giant with an anatomically incorrect package, and the brothers soon found themselves pursuing Abas' lost throne. Led by a local creature named Renaldo, they barely survived the challenge to awaken the Forgotten Army, all the while battling minions of the Dark Queen. Abas was told to cross the Bridge of Endings and regain his True Form, them retake Talpik across the Glass Lake. Instead they ventured into the lair of the Great Worm and made their way back into their world. The Worm required an 'outlander' sacrifice, and Urul fit the bill, especially given that he was unconscious at the time.

Once inside the halls of the Ordeal of Fire they emerged into the Hammer Flats and found the road. Renaldo turned out to be some form of troll who was terrified of sunlight so they packed him up in blankets. Some King's Men kindly died and left them their horses, and the brothers made their way West, the unconscious beast still in tow. Time had passed more quickly while they were gone and the weather was cold in the onset of winter.

**Winter 23 to 25, 3117n Session: June 18, 2011**

Bad weather with sleet and hail drove the brothers into one of the many shallow cracks of the Hammer Flats. Then they were attacked by worg-riding orcs of the "red foot" clan. It was an ugly fight, Tiden, Garnet and Bassy died and the brothers didn't have much to show for it. The kobold from the caves (Took, with one arm) was still alive along with the Beast, whom they'd shaved and dressed. Orc-driven stirges took out most of their horses as they made their way west, but in the driving sleet and snow and their tracker dead they weren't sure where they were. They holed up in the night in a ruined windmill on the western edge of the flats, and ran into two soldiers who told them about the recent orc incursions from the mountains to the south, tied to the Iron King. One of the soldiers managed to die in the night, some terrible misunderstanding that involved being stabbed, and the other one fled.

The next day they headed northwest but wound up on the edge of Snake Gorge. Abas fell into a kobold pit. They asked about Shahaz and the Gorge Witch but learned nothing. They headed west along the edge of the gorge until they found a mud-brick village of leprous Malauris and spent the night on the edge of it in a barn. Abas made some interesting deals with some of the locals. The village was not in flames when they left. The bone-sled was in ruins and the weather wasn't getting better.

**Winter 25 to 34, 3117n Session: July 9, 2011**

The Brothers turned around and headed back to the Malauri leper village of Tasich on the edge of the Hammer Flats. They considered burning it to the ground. Several times. In the end they agreed to round up a dozen goats (or sheep) in return for a cart. A cart the villagers would have to build, which meant sending the Brothers out to find wood in a woodless region of the world. In the snow. Next to the infamous ravine called Snake Gorge. They were also warned about 'ice snakes'. Fahqu killed their new guide Torn (local villager) in a jealous rage as he eyed one of the Wives. They fed Took (one-armed kobold) to the Beast. They abandoned the goat errand and made their way to the rumored Mad Labyrinth. Which was located next to the only known wood. They brought their new seer Batrine (a legless one-good-eyed mad leper in a box).

They set out with the Brothers, the Wives (Violent and Chlo), the Beast, Friar Sweeney, Renaldo, Batrine and their new-new tracker, Biggs. They reached the only source of wood, a collection of landlocked ruined boats, and the Face of Teserius appeared over them. They had had a dream the night before, vomiting teeth, hair and nails while shitting body parts of all their victims, and they'd suspected it involved him. The Face taunted them and told they were oh-so-doomed, having reached the Mad Labyrinth of Zen the Half Minded. It also claimed to have found them thanks to Jir-Brazmoron, the little demon thing in the Ordeal of Fire. Biggs pondered leaving and Fahqu punched his head in. The ground opened up to reveal the labyrinth and a pair of flying monkeys started pelting them with feces. Abas captured one of them and did inappropriate things to it.

They made their way through the labyrinth, flying monkey in tow. Batrine died. They lost the last of their horses. The whole time they were enticed with visions of a warm, happy village that awaited them at the other end, only to see the more attractive villages die off as they spent eight days in the labyrinth. They fought a giant snake, made it over acid pits, fought iron monsters and sand zombies. They lost the flying monkey.

**Winter 34 to 38, 3117n Session: September 1, 2011**

The "Mad Labyrinth of Zen the Mad" took its toll on the Brothers. The Beast scooped up Chlo and ran for it, getting the two killed as he leaped down a flaming chute to a lower level. The brothers followed them down said flaming chute. Past that the Brothers faced a violent monk, a room of saw blades and gladiatorial giants, some randy pixie-things, and an inanimate statue. They also, inconceivably, survived the Room With One Chicken. They emerged back into the labyrinth again where they found a petrified minotaur, a LOT of pit traps, some sand zombies, and then the beckoning village at the exit.

The village didn't hold their interest very long, and between the choice of returning to the Hammer Flats or a place called the Forbidden Room, they opted for the Forbidden Room. They stepped through and found themselves a thousand miles away in the Borderlands of Wallendahr at the infamous and improbable Blue Boar Inn.

> Put more eloquently by Corbin/Fahqu: "The two brothers stomped, chomped and [deleted] stuff up on their way to yet more glory. [deleted] were killed, [deleted] were saved (ie any party member still standing) and [deleted] all of us are riiiiiiiiich! Now in an inn where we can [deleted]."

**Winter 34 to 35, 3117n Session: October 7, 2011**

The Brothers spent the night at the Blue Boar Inn. They met three witches, fleeced four halflings, traded said halflings to the witches, joined up with the Berlin Brothers, met Artis the Dire Wolf and Barry, and an adventurer named Cricket. Their bag of holding vomited up its contents and died. They tried to unlock a portal in one of the crappers.

In the morning Abas made some poor choices and got bounced. Fahqu bartered with the witches and got him back. They left, Berlin Brothers and a tracker named Matilda in tow, heading for Hollis. Before they made it ten feet a dwarf got killed, windows were smashed, a musician got a hatchet to the head, and Matilda had his ankles chopped.

**Winter 35 to 36, 3117n Session: October 21, 2011**

The Brothers decided to go back into the inn. There was concern that breaking windows, hatcheting a guest and setting fire to the porch might make them unwelcome. They tied themselves together. Matilda died. They stepped onto the porch at the same time. Abas and the friar disappeared, and so did the inn.

Fahqu sent up flaming arrows in all directions. He also climbed a tree. In the falling snow visibility was poor. Fahqu led his group (Violent, a comatose Renaldo, and the Berlin Brothers) to investigate the mysterious fires that had erupted nearby. They ran into Simsil, who had been traveling to the inn. Fahqu remembered that he was important and they had been hoping to find him. With the blizzard and the missing inn they decided to join up and travel upriver to the nearest town. They spotted Dead Island in the river and the Berlin Brothers were determined to attack it. Fish became stranded on the island, Big Brick and Thigly were swept downriver and Simsil died (horribly). The sun set and Renaldo woke, able to sense Abas' location to the west. The remaining group (Fahqu, Violent, Renaldo) took the Berlin Brothers' long-haired mules and followed the river to Tania.

Abas was alone in the woods. And lost. He avoided a bear, killed an elk, avoided a fairie death pit, tolerated some elves, killed some gnolls, and met a talking aye-aye who claimed to be the Grand Wizard of the Cabal. He waved down a raft and made it to Tania. Once there the purplish gnoll blood covering his armor made him an instant hit, and he got a room at 'the biggest inn' in Tania: the Sign of the Bear on the square.

Fahqu bribed his way through the closed east gate and got a room at 'the best inn' in Tania: the Queen's Placard in Burgmond. By midnight they had added Tiki and Cake to the group, and soon got word of Abas from the pimp Trance.

By morning of the 36th (Bode, the 5th day of the week) they were all together in the third floor room of the Queen's Placard.

## Recently Dead:

Matilda (hunter/trapper), Chlo (sister-daughter-wife), Yeti-Beast-Thing, Batrine (mad leper), Took (one-armed kobold), Torn (leper guide), Biggs (leper guide), Garnet (the only functional thief the party ever had), Tiden (former Cobra), Bassy (prostitute), Urul (sacrificed to the Great Worm), Tet, Brin, Farcus, Bubba, Ilar (sacrificed), Carpenter, Nancy, Hassan, Kihm, Razill, Tamiq, (soldiers: Tim, Barsh and Noggin), Haktis, Clerk, Old Woman, Sick Guy, Rumpo, Old Jane (Old Glory Hole), Dox, Dallin (Kihm's brother), Andahaine ('Andaboo', tick), Iyit, Kimmy, Ox, Tahik (tick), Milit (tick), Ordol, Mellon-Headed Infant, Callous and Mede ("the brothers"), Naqbled, Gums, Edna?, Dung, Olivia, Death, Hasan's soldiers

# STABMASTER 8: MAGIC

(draft of the new magic rules from Stabmaster 8: Blood Market)

## What is Magic?

Magic has many forms. There is the channeled power of the priests, the rituals and formulas of the mages, the imbuements and elicitations of the eldar, the glamours of the faie, and the hedge magic of the shamans and witches.

Currently the first two are the only player character options.

Mages pull their power directly from the residual Creation forces, long running flows of power in the earth and air, called the Aigrim. They do this through stylized and ancient rituals referred to (broadly) as the Arcanum. There are a dozen forms and variations, but they are all ultimately variants on the same principal.

Clerics and priests channel magic from the Veil, and druids elicit their magic from the residual Creation spark of natural elements (called Malah), much like the eldar.

## The Arcanum

Mages use the magic generally referred to as the Arcanum, a formalized set of rituals that invokes the otherwise dormant forces of the Aigrim that pepper the world, lost remnants of the Creation Spark.

In practice this means Magic-User and Illusionist spell lists from 1st edition AD&D. Spells from other books and editions, like the Tome of Magic, are fine too.

There is also a spontaneous use of magic using raw vis.

## Casting Ritual Spells

Basics:

**Vis**: Mages get vis (manna: http://arsmagica.wikia.com/wiki/Vis ) based on their Intelligence and class level. 1 die of vis per level plus an extra die every so many levels based on Intelligence

| Intelligence | Level Bonus |
|---|---|
| up to 15 | every 5 |
| 16 | every 4 |
| 17 | every 3 |
| 18 | every 2 |
| 19 | every 1 |

**The Die Pool**: One die plus a die for every point of vis the mage has left. Die pools use six-sided dice. By default each die that rolls a 4, 5 or 6 counts (called a 'pip') and dice that roll 1, 2 or 3 are ignored.

Die Pool = 1 die plus remaining vis

**Cost**: Spells cost a point of vis per level of the spell.

**Casting**: You roll your die pool and need to get a number of 'pips' equal or higher than the level of the spell.

**Casting Success Range**: for every 'pip' you roll ABOVE THE REQUIRED number, you can do one of these: add 10% to range, add 10% to duration, add 1HP of damage. This is capped at 4 bonus pips (ie you can only use up to 4 pips this way).

If you don't roll any pips your Control Die goes up by 1 (but not if it's 4 or higher).

**Botches and Boons**: Rolling more 1s than 6s is a botch. Rolling more 6s than 1s is a boon. Boons are simple: for every boon, you roll another die and add it to the pool (and on boon dice 1s don't count towards a botch, but a 6 does count as another boon). Botches require a control test to see if you lose control of the spell. Botches and boons only happen in crisis situations like combat or high stress/consequence events.

**The Control Die**: The control die is a separate six-sided die used as a marker. It starts at 1, which means when rolling a control test each die in your pool only needs to beat a 1 to count as a 'pip'. The number of pips you need to roll is equal to the spell level. The die pool is the same as the one used for the spell you are trying to control.

Any time you cast a spell you can 'tap' your control die for a free die to be added to your pool. This raises your control die number by 1 each time (and can only be done in increments of one).

**Resetting the Control Die**: after a successful control test it gets lowered by 1.

**Spell Subversion**: when there's another mage within target range of a spell, they can attempt to subvert control of the spell from the caster. If they spend as much vis as the caster + the number of pips he made over the target number, they can force a control test (note that they have to guess how much to spend and then see if it's enough).

If the caster succeeds in casting the spell but fails the control test then the other mage (the 'subverter') gains control of it with the original caster as the point of origin. The subverter does not have the option to not cast. They can change the target, direction or other parts of the subverted spell.

If the caster makes their control test but fails to cast the spell the other mage can suck the spent vis into their own pool. Subversions works with Ritual spells too (e.g. cleric/priest spells) but only to force a control test, not gain control or steal vis since the nature and source of the spell is different.

**Modifiers**: casting in the mage's own lab adds 1 to the die pool. Taking twice as long as needed in non-stress situations adds 1 to the die pool. Casting with the mage's own staff allows you to ignore the 'no pips rolled' penalty.

- Casting in own lab = 1 extra die
- Taking twice as long = 1 extra die
- Using mage's staff = ignore 'no pips rolled' penalty

**Metal**: (it’s like a tinfoil hat) it’s hard to pull the Aigrim through metal, so the more metal the mage has on them the harder to cast. An exception is gold and silver. There are a few rare and expensive armors using a strange mix of metals made especially for mages that help offset the penalty.

- Metal Penalty: every 2 points requires an extra pip to cast
  - Shield = 2
  - Metal Helmet = 1
  - Studded Leather = 1
  - Ringmail = 2
  - Chainmail = 3
  - Banded Mail = 3
  - Plate = 3
  - Swords, metal weapons = 1
  - Pots and Pans = 1
  - Copper coins = 1 per 100 or so coins

**Concentration**: getting pushed hard, tackled or otherwise manhandled ruins the spell and requires a control test to avoid a botched spell (vs. just losing the vis)

> MAYBE: some form of "concentration roll" or just a level check [and maybe create some special 'concentration' pre-spell or Affinity that allows the mage to stay concentrated if injured but raises the target number by 1 for each HP of damage, and damage over a quarter (rounded favorably) of the mage's current HP total ruins the spell and requires a control test -- but only if the damage isn't knocking him over or off his feet]

**Botching**: if you fail a control test you botch the spell and lose the vis. Roll a d20 and add the number of pips you failed to the roll (target number minus pips rolled)

Getting 30 or higher would mean rolling a 20 while attempting a 9$^{th}$ level spell with penalties (or maybe a 7$^{th}$ or 8$^{th}$ level with a ton of penalties)

2-3 Spell fails, no effect

[a list in between the lowest score (2) and highest (30+)]
Fails, random odd non-lethal effects in vicinity
Additional d4 vis lost
Caster stunned for d4 combat rounds
Caster and anyone within 12 feet radius stunned (ST for non-casters)
Random other spell in repertoire cast (same level, random choice of target etc)
Explosion: fireball range 5 feet for each missed pip, d6 damage for each missed pip
Explosion: lightning d4 random targets within 5 feet for each missed pip, d6 damage for each missed pip
Explosion: blinding range 5 feet for each missed pip (ST for non-casters)
Caster and others stunned (no save, closest targets, as many as pips missed)
Caser changes hair color, all potions within range lose magical properties (5 feet per missed pip)

30+ Catastrophic event of game changing proportions; accompanied by frogs raining from the sky, water turning to blood, the kind of stuff that becomes the foundation of new religions

## Spell Lists & Grimoires

The lifelong pursuit of any serious magician is acquisition of new spells for their grimoire. The more spells the more powerful the mage. To learn a new spell a mage has to successfully cast it (at one die higher difficulty) then transcribe it into their own grimoire.

There's no limit on how many spells a mage can have in their repertoire, but they can only add spells they are able to cast. Spells from other books are fine, but generally speaking we're using the AD&D 1st edition. Any higher level spells or spells they can't cast (lack of spell components or repeated failed rolls) has to wait.

**Grimoire**: a grimoire has to be written out by the mage and includes all the spells they can cast. Sure, it could be several moleskin notebooks, but generally it's one fat book. The expense of one is part of that. Special paper, binding, etc. Read Magic is used to read grimoires unless they're your own. There are different forms and ways to encrypt, so there's no telling how hard it will be to take spells from a grimoire you find.

**Mage's Staff**: like a grimoire, a staff is a magical item bound to a particular mage. Usually it gains this power by proximity to the mage in their lab over a prolonged period (and can lose it over time as well if away from the mage). A mage's staff counts as a magical weapon.

## Raw Vis: Spontaneous Magic and Shaping the Form

Spells are just the most efficient way of casting magic. Mages can channel vis directly into actions as well.

[all of this needs to be developed obviously]

Push

Fire/Ice

Lightning/Weather

Animals

Illusion

Influence

## The Ritual Arts

Religious magic pulls its power from the Spirit World, whether it's called the Listar or Myrgbon, the Celestial World or the Heavens. The caster channels power from a divine source, though druids may consider the natural world itself to be that source.

In practice this means Cleric and Druid spell lists from 1st edition AD&D. Spells from other books and editions, like the Tome of Magic, are fine too.

Unlike mages, priests have access to most of the spells on the list. There may be a few spells that don't suit the religion (or have to be cast in reverse form, like Harm vs. Heal). The rule is that they can cast all but 3 spells of each level (using the AD&D list). Other than spells (if any) prohibited by the religion, the player can choose which spells they can't cast. Spells from other books can be added as needed, but not whole lists.

**Casting**: for now it's the same as for mages.

**Modifiers**:

- Hallowed Ground: 2 extra dice (or 2 more pip required if it's a directly opposed religious ground)
- Aligned Holy Ground (other religion, same ethos): 1 extra die (or 1 more pip required if it's an opposed ethos)

## Raw Vis: Having a God Moment

Like mages, priests can channel vis directly. They pull it from the Veil, but without an ordained spell it's not efficient.

Heal/Harm

Clean/Spoil

Awe

Protect

Bless

Blood Transference (taking injury in place of someone else)

# The Borderlands of Wallendahr

(from the World section of the Telrhin site)

No hack-n-slash world worth its salt would be complete without an untamed edge of the world. In Telrhin, this is the region of Wallendahr, better known simply as the Borderlands. Tucked below the Cairn Mountains along the Norhtbound River, it's a forested swath of land full of ravines, caves, hills and rivers.

> **The Borderlands** (Encyclopaedia Telrhinica):
> "The region of Wallendahr (also called Westfold) along the western edge of the Cairn Hills in the wide valley formed by the Northbound River; a long crescent of forested and untamed land with small outposts of civilization scattered across it."

The main settlements are Tania, Hollis and some others along the Northbound like Northmund, Tarris and Pillon.

The people here are a breed of Westrons (called Wallens), along with a lot of halflings, Dremen elves, orcs and gnolls.

> **City of Tania** (Encyclopaedia Telrhinica): "Sole hub of civilization in the Borderlands of Wallendahr, at the crux of the Havenflow, Blackwater and Northbound rivers in the Andarin Forest. A city of mud streets surrounding a huge keep perched over the rivers, center of trade in the Borderlands. The long winter means steep rooftops and narrow streets along with a prolific brewing industry (try the Black Gin). "

**Topography of a Wilderness**

Wallendahr is covered in a thick blanket of forest hiding hills, valleys and ravines. It's cross-cut with streams and long lakes like the Black Lake, Lake of Ink and the lovely Slithering Lake.

The Borderlands are weedged between the Cairn Hills to the East and the Ragnaveil Mountains to the West, with the Tohradun Mountains in between, all of which meet up to the South where the Havenwakes divide.

The Andarin Woods surround the central area of Wallendahr where the Havenflow, Northbound and Blackwater meet. Across the Tohradun Mountains is the untamed Black Forest, and stretching towards the Weatherpeaks along the Northbound River are the Longsought Woods.

**Bestiary**

While enjoying the flora and fauna of the lovely Borderlands you may run into wolves, worgs, faieries, gnolls, orcs, wyverns, all manner of oversized snakes, bears, ogres, giant pikes, elves and halflings. Unlike the Lowlands, not a place for werewolves: instead, the Borderlands are best known for vampires.

On the less lethal end there are pandas and furry hippos called river cows. There are also moose, elks, badgers and flying squirrels.

**Practiced Religions**

Moons, Sylas, Bel, Falasrion, and the Secret Circle for the most part. Orcs in Wallendahr are converts to Thar-Emykl, and gnolls follow an offshoot of Astavianism. The Field Guide has more on Gods and Religion.

**Beer, Pipeweed and Local Cuisine**

Local beer is dark and generally not very good. The breweries in Tania make most of it, mainly Wolf Ale (decent ale) and Black Steam (crap lager). The Blue Boar is home to a famous pint called Honey Zen and Hollis exports a popular stout called Two Bites.

Wallendahr is home to something called Black Gin, which is a silty gin that Ice Cube would be proud of. There's also Ausgourdian schnapps and port.

Grotch, Victory Cups and Mother's Milk are common drinks across the bars of the Borderlands.

The local tobacco is Westfold Leaf, and the halflings swear by it. King's Mark from neighboring Zhan is the far better leaf.

Check out the Field Guide page for more on pints and tobacco.

Cuisine seems to involve a lot of kidney pies, rabbit and venison. This is also coffee country, with a lot of chicory mixed in.

> **The Blue Boar Inn**
>
> (From the Encyclopaedia Entry) "The infamous Last Inn of the Borderlands, an improbable bar and inn generally found in the southwestern edge of the forest of Andar, home to trappers, hunters, adventurers, rogues and strange creatures, supposedly built by the crazed wizard Zen."
>
> Which pretty much sums it up. A fine spot for adventure if you can find it.

# Tavern Tales

(from the Field Guide appendices)

A few stories, songs and tall tales you might hear around the campfire or late at night at the tavern with a good pint. These are tales you'd hear in the Lowlands, and doesn't include many of the famous stories told elsewhere in the world. You may also want to read A Brief History of the World.

So pull up to the fire and pour yourself a pint of Stone Ale, fill your pipe with some Founders Leaf, and sit back for a few tavern tales...

**Girithlin Myrdstone**
Songs and tales of one of the adventurers in Karldaband's band 'the Star Children', who settled in Kinghave, friends with Thane Gorgonbane and an ally to House Linian, led various expeditions into the Weatherpeaks to fight dragons, giants and orcs, defeated the Semesi pirate brotherhood and had a talking monkey; his old keep is at the heart of Merdstone gate in the Lark-Han.

**Karldanian and the Hand of Her Dark Majesty**
The story of Karldanian, whose forefather was the great Karldaband, and how he severed the sword hand of Talonasi at the Battle of Victory Plains, ending the Great War.

**"The Garmin Tales"**
A series of horrid and grim parables in which the moral is that kids should never leave the village or farm. In various tales kids get eaten by fairies, killed by orcs, plucked up by griffons, raped by bears, and sold into slavery by witches.

**The Banishment of the Malauri**
The legend of how the Malauri, one of the old Lowlander tribes, were banished from the Council and their lands taken when they betrayed the Treaty of Kings.

**Song of the Founder**
An ancient dwarven song about King Moradine the Founder who led the dwarves of Rhask-Edaan across the Valek to the Weatherpeaks. The original dwarven version is fourteen hours long in the telling, like other dwarven epics including the Song of Galek and the Song of Fain.

**Magradin and Luvinda**
In the time before there were gods, two lovers lived in the center of the world, ancient creatures the size of kingdoms, tasked with the creation of the world. So in love were they that they never left one another's side, one becoming the Weatherpeak Mountains and the other the Valek Sea. In some versions Luvinda is one of the Moon Sisters, wooed onto the earth by Magradin where she becomes the sea.

**The Baroness**
A song that tells the story of Zodmius and his beloved wife, the Baroness, and how she was murdered by the witch Ninz and Zodmius' bitter revenge.

**Karldaband**
Various tales of the great adventurer Kardlaband Elf-Friend and his band the Star Children: slaying the dragon Garvadil, driving Rouman the Black from Maldingard, and his eventual death at the hands of Talonasi in the North Kingdoms.

**The Great Demon of Darkfold**
The tale of the adventuring band Sons of Fantasy and how they entered Darkfold and slew the Great Demon.

**Ankhor-Alagon and the Egg of Endrik**
The story of Endrik Stonebearer, the great dwarven king, who found the unhatched egg of a dragon and stayed with it until it hatched; the dragon, Ankhor-Alagon, was a loyal friend for the rest of Endrik's life, snatching his dying body from the Sinland Wastes after the doomed March of 330n.

**The Slaying of Shem**
The tale of the adventuring band Sons of Fantasy when they felled the ancient dragon Shem and opened the pass over the mountains.

**Alfik and Emlios**
The story of the dwarf Alfik of the House of Fain and his friendship with the elf Emlios of the Sinland forest, how their friendship changed the world and led to the Elder Alliance and the Goblin Wars.

**Failas and Nisleon**
A old legend of the Eldar times, about the High Thale faie Failas and his love for Nisleon, the two reuniting eternally every spring in the Lowlands and parting in fall.

**The Obelisk of the Kingmage**
How the adventuring band Renegades answered Zodmius' challenge and brought the ancient Destinite obelisk from the edge of the world to where it stands now in Lark-han.

**Pirates!**
Various pirate tales, like the stories of Fyrth One-Eye discovering the ruins of the Everbad or stealing the Eye of Seht.

**Madinol the Mad**
Tales of Madinol, a dwarven hero and adventurer who fought in the Elder Wars, famous for his drinking and debauchery as well as his lute and gift of storytelling, and great-great-great-grandfather of Mard-Zorin, a famous Zhanian engineer and craftsman who helped design the defenses during the Siege of the Dark Queen in Tarlahan.

**The Black War and the Siege**

The long and far reaching war from six centuries back when the Dark Queen Talonasi's war reached through the mountains into the Lowlands (also called the Great War). Though ultimately all of the major cities in the Lowlands survived, the all-out Siege of Lark-Han was an epic struggle that turned the tide.

**Kipox Thief**

Various stories about the halfling adventurer, all varying in their accuracy, about how he helped kill the Demon of Darkfold with the Sons of Fantasy, stole a jewel the size of an elephant's heart from the Elephant Tower, rescued his mother from a demon but not before he ate her fingers, his infamous orc friend Og, how he and the Renegades brought the Obelisk of the Kingmage back from the edge of the world, how he escaped the Isle of Seven Deaths, how he murdered the Padishah of Bardor and made himself Vizier of Ohormay, how saying his name backwards three times will summon him, how well he could play a flute, and of course how he tricked the Enclave of Justice into freeing him by winning a game of darts.

**Willian the Grey**

Stories about the half-elf adventurer Willian and his famous vorpal blade, all varying in their accuracy: how he dealt the killing blow to the Demon of Darkfold with the Sons of Fantasy, how he rescued his friend Boarmere from the Scavengers only to have him die in his arms, slew the great dragon Shem to open the mountain pass, dueled a demon to become Baron of Reichenhall, drew the vorpal sword from the deeps of the mountains set there as a test of his god Alumna, how he fought a vampire lord to free the people of Crebenfold, and how he is said to be the demigod son of Alumna.

**Aquilius Lief**

Tales of the famous half-elven hero, how he founded the Sons of Fantasy, how he slew the great dragon of the Scarlet Hills, the demon vampire of Crebenfold, fought 3 duels with Manda Crowly of the Scavengers, his loyal companion Lance, how he slew the Great Demon of Darkfold, the mysterious death of his friend Dragonwing, how he has a magical flying horse for a mount, saved scores of towns such as Bywater and Uri, and became Marquis of Derris.

**Morid the Hawk**

Various tales of the famous Lowlands thief and adventurer Morid, famous for stealing the Dragon Ruby from the Padishah of Bardor and the only person to have escaped the Labyrinth of Souls in the Black Cairn.

**Kaymon of Ardor**

Lowland hero and knight of Gorgmir, Kaymon is famous for his duel with Black Gradthelion (black knight of Thar-Emykl) and the rescue of Prince Latani of Zolna from the clutches of the dragon Shem.

# A Few Expressions

(from the Field Guide sidebar)

**Cog** ("Orc Hog"): "you cog, you spilled yer beer on me"; "you filthy piece of cog"; "that tastes like cog"

**Elfed** (tricked, played): "you've been elfed!"

**Grotch** ("Gruumsh's Crotch"): "oh grotch, I forgot to lock the door"

**"It's just glamour"** (as in "it isn't real, just fairie glamour")

**Mig** (pejorative for Malauri): "no migs, dogs or orcs allowed"

**"Migged It"**: "I really migged that up"

**Prophet's Eye** ("bullshit"; Meledian slang, referring to the Prophet's a-hole): "Prophet's Eye! You lying piece of cog!"

**Seneca's Shawl** (Rayikian slang): "sweet Seneca's Shawl, what is this smell?"

**Shorts** (Lowlander slang for dwarves): "what have the shorts ever done for us?"

**Sweet Moons**: "Sweet Moons! That is one ugly baby!"

**Vig** (slang for Vijmani): "you filthy vig"

**"Long Knife Take You"** (Lowlander curse, reference to the dark cults of Ryrg Velkrin) "may the Long Knife take you!" or even "given the Long Knife" (as in 'totally screwed')

**Talmuth / Lunmuth**: 4 weeks or 3 weeks, based on the two lunar months

**Troll Bath** (burning someone alive): "give those heretics a good troll bath"

# Gods & Religions

(from the Field Guide to the Lowlands)

## Introduction

People in the Lowlands are a gullible lot willing to follow anything. For the most part that means the Westron traditions of the Moon cults, Sylasian star cult and of course the sea god Valek (and his sister Varas). To the east over the Spine there's still a strong presence of the Elephant God, and converts to Rayik keep popping up like rats in a Bardorian vomit trough. In the Headlands to the west, however, the Meledians and Astavians are the dominant believers.

And of course there are the less common but ubiquitous followers of the luck god Bel, the snake cult of Seht, and the (usually) secretive worshippers of Thar Emykl, Ryrg Velkrin and the rest of the so-called 'dark' gods.

**What Are the Gods?**

When the world was young, in the throes of the Great Creation, there were no gods. Just powerful creatures in a world of myth and magic. As the chaos subsided and the world shed the skin of this early incarnation, some of the magic and fantasy was squeezed out, the ancient Creation Beasts and the Eldar finding refuge in the lost corners of the world. Much of this is the Second World, an inner world of secret places. But beyond this there came a place called the Listar, the Spirit World, the place beyond all of reality tethered to it by a tenuous sense of memory, faith and origin. The place beyond the Veil of Dreams.

The Listar is the Outworld, the home of great forces and creatures too large to fit into the narrowing definitions of the emerging Middle World. It's fed by the dreams, spirits and beliefs of the living world, and over time the creatures there became the gods, watching and leading the living, empowered by their fervor and faith.

None of this is known to the poor saps who fill the churches.

**The Listar and the Afterlife of the Spirit World**

In the Mythic era of the early world the eldar creatures were of such a nature that they existed well beyond the death of their corporeal body. They lived on as spirits, found new hosts or grew new mortal coils. Over time the ones without a body found themselves fading away into the surrounding Veil of Dreams, discovering deep within it another world they could shape to their liking. Eventually there were so many creatures there a cohesive world evolved, forming the basis of the Listar (Spirit World) of today.

So who makes it into the afterlife? Average folks just die, whatever spiritual essence they may have had evaporating like that of other animals. Some people's spirits hold together and wander into the Veil, either guided by forces of their gods or their own determination. Of these many get lost in the Veil, wandering fruitlessly, devolving over time. Some spirits linger close to where they died, drawn back to the living world, ghosts and shadows of their former selves.

But not everything is drawn to the Spirit World. Elves are pulled into the Second World, and (possibly) the Suthri. Elves can even lose their ties to the living world over their long lives and slip into the Hollows between worlds, Lost Ones who may never reach the Second World. And who knows what happens to dwarves: they'll tell you they go back into the earth to sleep with the Maker.

# A Synopsis of the Major Religions in the Lowlands

## Tala and Luna

An old religion with a loosely organized structure, practiced widely among Westrons and others. Observances vary by region, and in many places the two gods are worshiped separately. In the Lowlands, for instance, most towns and villages have a church to Tala but only a small shrine to Luna inside it. Tala is associated with wisdom/fertility and Luna is associated with wile and luck, often called the Thief's Moon.

Symbols: gray and red moons (often concentric), gray and red colors, with a gray wolf symbol occasional associated with Tala as well.

## Valek and Varas

Valek the Sea God and his Sister Varas, Goddess of Witchcraft and the Spirit World. This is the widespread faith of the Lowlands and most of the inland sea, a wrathful storm god and his sister who is essentially the goddess of the underworld.

In rural and conservative circles, Valek is a vengeance god, a god of wrath and punishment, to be placated by prayers and supplications. Traditionally a spring sacrifice is made, which used to involve chucking a virgin into the sea. In the last few centuries a progressive variant has gained momentum (formally known as the Tigle Order of Valek), with a benevolent view of Valek as the bountiful, the protector. Rule of thumb: the more teeth the locals have the more likely they follow the Tigle Order.

Long pilgrimages are made by the poor and sick to the great temple of Zolna, with long lines of blue-cloaked followers making their way down the Tarlahanian road.

Symbols: dark blue and wave symbols, some older orthodox groups use a storm cloud with lightning, and the Tigle order often add a fish.

## Sylas, goddess of trade and travel

Sylasians follow the star goddess Sylas, an old pastoral cult popular with merchants, travelers, sailors, adventurers and some druidic cults in the Lowlands. As worshiped in rural farming communities she's also a fertility goddess.

Symbols: white colors and a silver star (the North Star).

## The Rayikian Faith

Founded by the prophet Rayik, the church is a pantheon of gods all subserviant to Septar and Seneca, the divine couple. There is some debate on which gods fill out the rest of the pantheon, with local gods in different parts of the world getting assimilated and absorbed. Like Meledians, Rayikians put their stock in an eternal afterlife.

The main gods of the order include: Septar (Sky God), Seneca (Purity and Healing), Argos (forging and craft), Tama (Lust and Sleep), Carna (War), Senguer (Creativity and Commerce), Sarides (Water), Savana (Strength), Tempes (Prosperity and Fertility)

Symbols: varying by god, the overall religion is represented by an X.

## Meledian Faith

Meledians are an evolution of the Astavian sun god Gahl, who came to the prophet Meledehin and dencounced his divine brethren as "shadow gods", booze as "poison of the dwarves" and shellfish as abominations of the Valek cult. Meledians are monotheists and emphasize the eternal afterlife over the current "life test" of the real world. For them the afterlife can pay out big if you follow the faith and have no sense of irony.

Symbols: blazing gold sun, gold colors along with gray.

## Astavian Faith

Animism gone wrong, Astavians follow a long list of gods with animal and nature qualities, including their appearance. For Astavians the virtues of the living impact the spiritual rest and well being of their ancestors, the afterlife seen as a miserable spirit world where the best one can hope for is a dreamless slumber. The exception is a special form of apotheosis reserved for the ruling elite.

Principle gods: Relt (Crops), Talmon (Magic), Kinsut (Death), Gahl (Sun), Bast (Thieves), Eris (Chaos and drunkeness). Seht is sometimes included as the god of sorcery and snakes.

Symbols: varying symbols for each god, usually an animal head, and during holy months men usually wear a kufi, a head covering associated with Astavians in the minds of most people.

## Bel, god of luck (and thieves)

> **A Few Thoughts on Bel from Kipox** (2-26-2010)
> Bel helps me steal lots of stuff and stab the occasional fat guy. He makes me small and good looking. He also allows me to play a fairly mean flute. I killed a kobold with my flute once. This is all very cool. A ghost made me look older than my dad. That was much less cool. But I squished him. The ghost, not my dad. The squishing of the ghost made things cool again. My friend is Og. Og is funny. He doesn't smell good, though. I have been planning to steal something very powerful for ages now, but Chris hasn't let me play for a very long time so I haven't been able to yet. Once I steal this very powerful thing, though, I am going to put it on my head, dance around like a mincing elf, then uriinate on it. I will do these things in that precise order. I would not wish to reverse the order in which I do these things. I would have urine in my hair. I will then loudly assert that Bel is the most awesome dude ever. This is true. Luck frees us from the fates. Life is short. Live it randomly. Live it fully. Take a chance. Take control. Good luck. Bel likes cheese.

An old favorite of sailors, merchants and thieves, Bel is an ancient religion that has co-existed with others for three thousand years. Competing with Luna in the Lowlands, Bel's following is mostly relegated to the cities and coasts. Churches are small affairs, home to a variety of charities and a good resource for adventurers in a tight spot.

Symbol: a coin, sometimes gold, and of course for the Brown Order and Grey Order of Belian monks use brown and grey...

## Seht, god of sorcery and deception

Seht is sometimes worshipped as part of the Astavian faith, and the roots of the religion can trace to the mystery cult of the Shadisi Oracles, in which the Snake Oracle is one of the more popular.

In practice Seht is god of mages and wizards who want the fast track to power. The faith calls for a lot of debaucherous all nighters with dancing, sex and human sacrifice -- which is not as fun as it sounds when you consider it's mostly magic users.

Symbols: serpentine snake, black colors.

## The Elephant Cult, god of wisdom and tradition

An ancient Grasslands animist cult, one of the tenants is re-incarnation, the ultimate goal of which is to re-incarnate as a nature spirit. The religion is common in Akania among Akani and Westrons, and has its main temple in Dryer Mob.

## The Secret Circle

The Circle is an infernal order of dark gods, most often worshipped in the form of Ryrg-Velkrin or Thar-Emykl. There are secret cults to Ryrg-Velkrin (god of suffering and pain) across the Lowlands, part of the Brotherhood of Long Knives.

Also in the order: Bendhel (war), Tassvori Irthgon (murder and deception), Marashil (secrecy and dreams)

## Kiyotamaka and the Khitagani Gods

There are a handful of religions and gods in Khitagan but the main religion follows the dragon god Kiyotamaka. Kiyotamaka, so it goes, was flying around destroying the world for all time when he ran into a Khitagani woman who wasn't afraid of him. He was so impressed he spared her people and married her. Every empress after her is her re-incarnation.

One of the tenants is "forward", the idea that your virtue as a person impacts the fate of your descendents (their good fortune and spiritual happiness). The afterlife is the "well of the unknown" and not a large focus of the faith.

Symbol: stylized dragon eye

## The Suthri Dragon Gods ("Augustans")

The Augustans hold that there were five great gods on their mythic island (which later sank), and these five gods include Kiyotamaka and Falasrion as well as the three core gods of the Suthri: Ninrandivel, Greslionor and Tyrsinel.

Called Augustans for the early leader and prophet August don Ralendahr.

Symbols: stylized dragons, silver, gray or black colors.

## The Dwarves, Elves and Other Gods

The Elder races and most of the non-human races have their own gods, though some of them follow other faiths. Traditionally, the elves follow Falasrion, the dwarves follow the Maker and his order, and the orcs follow Gruumsh. Kobolds pray to Lokti. Gnolls follow an offshoot of Astavianism.

The four gods of the dwarves: Mahal (creation), Jolival (creativity), Thenkragen (war), Virn Thakloth (death)

# No Adventure is Complete Without A Good Pint

(Epilogue to the Field Guide to the Lowlands)

At the end of the day, covered in the dust of a few tombs, any adventurer worth their salt makes their way to the pub. A place to kick back, brag about the day's victories, mourn the losses, and enjoy a good pint.

Life would be hell without a good pint.

Fortunately the brewers in Lark-Han are up to the task. Drawing on the dwarven tradition of dark ales and strong meads, Lark-Han also produces lagers like Artisan Gold and Lark-Han's Best. The city does produce a few liquors and wines, but local brewing is mostly about things that go in pints. Knowing one's drink is an essential tool for anyone trying to make their mark in the Great City.

**Meads**: A mix of honey and water. Traditional dwarven mead (such as Old Metheglin) is rich and dry and usually spiced. There are also sweet varieties, often called 'honey mead' (like Artos' Wasp Brew). Mead is considered to be an aphrodisiac if consumed on a daily basis (hence the expression honeymoon).

**Ales**: Unlike beers, Ale in Lark-Han is a traditional dwarven brew of 'unhopped' yeast, water, and malt. The novelty of adding hops to ale is considered heresy in Lark-Han, and foreigners who are dumb enough to order it that way are just begging for a good kick in the jimmy (Ordering Var's Hopped Ale, which is really a stout, is the sole exception). Girithlin's Stone Ale is the dwarven favorite, followed by Var's Ground Axe and, for the truly brave, Artos' Orc Spit.

**Stouts and Porters**: This is the true brew of the Lowlands, with many varieties such as Fat Badger, Dock Brew and Hopped Ale. Characterized by a prominent head of released carbon dioxide and a sharper, more strongly hopped flavor than lagers.

**Lagers**: This used to be watered down cheap refreshment for the dock laborers, but over the centuries lagers, which are light and distinguished by their clear golden look, have become a favorite of the poorer classes. The two main varieties are Vars' Artisan Gold, and the bottom-of-the-barrel Lark-Han's Best from Artos. Few self-respecting dwarves drink lagers.

**Wines**: Wine, although common in the Lowlands and most other parts of the world, is not a dwarven thing. The largest (and arguably best) vineyards are in the Delshiv wine country of the Margron Vale, bottled by the Leitr family and sold mostly through House Willard.

Outside the city the story changes a little. The wine country of around the Margron Vale is famous for its Margron Noirs, Malvordains and Delshiv Malbecs. The highlands of Tesladain are prolific brewers of whiskeys and also enjoy a good port.

**Liquor**: In Lark-Han Girithlin makes a good bourbon, and Vars makes a good gin. Artos pumps out a gin that's easily mistaken for paint thinner, but for the price no one complains.

**Brand Cheat Sheet**:

Meads: Old Metheglin (Girithlin, good stuff), Wasp Brew (Artos, sweet)

Ales: Stone Ale (Girithlin, dwarven favorite ), Ground Axe (Vars, good stuff), Orc Spit (Artos, it ain't named that for nothing)

Stouts/Porters: Fat Badger (Artos, good stuff), Dock Brew (Girithlin, good stuff), Hopped Ale (Vars, good stuff)

Lagers: Artisan Gold (Vars, pretty decent), Lark-Han's Best (Artos, total crap), Ain Alhamaam (from Bardor, tastes like piss)

**Imported Stuff**: Except for rare exceptions (see Ain Alhamaam below), only wine and hard liquor are imported in any quantity. Wine comes in from Caberton, Kanton and Lanion, as does a lot of liquor (from Ausgourdian schnapps to Vijmanian absynth). Rum floats in from the East Isles (including the exotic Pearl Rum from Ildobar). A few ultra-exotic liquors make their way in from afar like Vanaheimian Scotch and the infamous Poppin Skuzzer of Dryer Mob.

## Pipe Weed and a Good Toke

Sure, a pint's the thing when the adventure's over, but on the long treks between the pub and the dungeon you need a good pipe.

**Kings Mark**: the good stuff, made by the dwarves in Roarden and Lindarin.

**Blue Demon**: real crap, but it's cheap and easy to find. From Tarlahan.

**Wallendahr Leaf**: though halfings swear by it (and sometimes call it Westfold Leaf), it's just middling stuff. Expensive since it comes from the Borderlands.

**Pirate's Bay**: one of several brands from Ildobar, good stuff if you can get it.

**Founders Leaf**: as good as Kings Mark, from Farhaven and made from another one of those damned secret dwarven formulas.

**Orc Toe**: rough stuff, sailors love it, puts hair on your chest. From Zolna.

One interesting import is the universally disliked Ain Alhamaam beer (a lager) from Bardor: it's semi-required for various religious and cultural ceremonies among the Bardorian ex-pat communities (Astavians, not Meledians), and curious outsiders can find it on tap at the Khas Turesti in Lark-Han.

## A Few Odd Drinks:

**Poppin Skuzzer**: ah, the Poppin Skuzzer, the true test of manhood. The drink itself is a clear potent herbal liquor (not unlike Chartreuse), but the catch is that it comes with two small vials: one red, one blue. The red makes it more potent, the blue makes it less potent. Adding blue AND red tastes

something awful and the blue transforms into red to make it twice as powerful. The last trick is that drinking all the blue without the drink will cure the common cold.

**Victory Cup**: rooted in battlefield traditions, a Victory Cup is best served out of a helmet filled with hard cider and a few laurel leaves. Bars often keep a battered helmet (often Halfling sized) on a peg for just this occasion.

**Pearl Rum**: a wonderfully smooth rum with a fat emerald green pearl in the bottle. Very expensive by the bottle, but less so if you get it by the glass (the house keeps the pearl).

**Mother's Milk**: goat's milk with whiskey, served hot. In the country it's often human breast milk instead.

**Dragon Fire**: it pours like sludge and glows like hot lava, but it's cool to the tongue. A dwarven brewing secret, it ain't cheap and after good meal of mutton there's nothing better. And it gets you stinking drunk without a hangover.

**Orc Eye**: a fresh egg, some 'tabasco' and gin. Yum.

**Vanaheimian Scotch**: packs a hell of a wallop and gives seasoned drinkers a gratifying buzz with little hangover. In d20 we used to roll a Con check to see if you fell off the barstool after a shot. All the way from Eastholm it's one of the most expensive drinks you can find (when you can find it).

**Grotch**: a shot made from all the crap in the bar's spill-guard.

# A Quick Glossary of Magical Herbs

(from the Field Guide appendices)

Lowlands herbs are marked with an asterisk * for easy reference. You may also want to check out the list of the more common magical items found in the Lowlands.

***Aconite** (root): known as monkshood, wolfsbane and friar's cap, the aroma from breaking this root is a mild sedative and is said to drive off werewolves (common, Grasslands, The Fold, Ugar, Lowlands, Southlands and Borderlands)

**Ankii Berry**: eating this berry instantly restores you as if you had just had a full night's rest . Overuse of the berry reduces Constitution for a few days (twice in a week -1, 3 times in a week -5) (rare, found in the Highlands and the Wilds)

**Ardis Flower**: eating the petals of an Ardis flower can restore most forms of temporary blindness (uncommon, found in the Highlands)

**Arlan** (leaf): applying a poultice of arlan heals d6 + 3 HP in 2 minutes. Wild Arland, or 'Common Arlan', yields d6 HP (common, found in the Highlands and Borderlands)

**Atigax** (root): boiling and drinking this root protects the eyes from intense light or glare, sudden or blinding light, and lasts about 9 hours (uncommon, found in Rakshem and Rooksholm)

***Belladonna** (plant): mixed with Breldiar in boiling saltwater can give the drinker limited "floating" powers for 10 or so minutes. Taken more than once in a year results in vomiting and hit point loss (uncommon, found in all temperate climates).

**Breldiar** (flower): mixed with other spell components a Breldiar flower doubles spell duration and halves casting time for most spells; however, for duration of spell the spellcaster's fighting level is at half and defensive adjustment from dexterity is cancelled (a side effect of the flower's effect is severe gas) (rare, found in the Highlands)

**Bright Blue Eyes** (flower): boiling and drinking the leaves of this flower improves vision and provides mild infravision (15 feet) for three hours. Takes about a minute to take effect (very rare, found in Rakshem)

***Burdock Root**: (boil and eat) treats and sometimes cures syphilis, boils and gout (uncommon, Ugar, Fold, Rackshem, Lowlands)

**Carefree Mustard** (seed): applying these seeds to a wound heals 3-30 HP and takes about an hour (very rare, from the Highland Mountains)

**Elben's Basket** (root): eating this root instantly "hastes" you for one melee round (a Constitution check is required or else you'll be incapacitated with heart pains for d4 melee rounds) (rare, found in Eastholm)

***Feldin Sap**: this sap can be used as a topical poison, causing 2 HP of damage to elves and 1 point to half-elves when it enters a wound. It is easy to apply to weapons and takes effect in the following melee round after injury (rare, found in the Lowlands and Borderlands)

***Finch Root**: this rare mountain vine is famous for its powers of foresight and premonition. Burning it and inhaling the fumes lets player, at any time during that session, re-roll one of their own skill checks, attack rolls or damage rolls because they "saw it coming". (rare, Weatherpeaks, Ophirs)

***Gorrin Leaf**: smoke this tobacco-like leaf to gain 2 HP for an hour, even exceeding your max (rare, Lowlands, The Fold)

***Hallas Berry**: eat this sour berry for a +2 on Saving Throws vs. Holy, last about an hour (uncommon, Lowlands, Fold, Grasslands)

***Limbus Grass**: a +4 saving throw or else tell the truth if eaten, but suspicious or unwilling recipients get an additional +2.

**Moonflower**: boil along with wild Arlan and eat to turn invisible (as spell, type 1) for 24 hours. Takes about 10 minutes for the effect to start. Boiling the flower alone yields infravision (60 feet) for six hours (rare, found in the East Isles and the Weatherpeaks)

**Saxifrage**: (flower) if eaten give +1 to saving throws for an hour. Rare, found in the Headlands.

***Sirillin Root**: the root of this hardy flower can be boiled with salt and spread on wounds to heal 1 additional HP for the next 4 nights (uncommon, Lowlands and Headlands)

**Splatfoot Goodwart**: these seeds can be dissolved and ingested to give a +1 to "holy" Saving Throws for good-aligned characters. Lasts 1 hour. Doubling the dosage has a 50% chance of adding another +1, or causing d12 damage from internal bleeding (although the first +1 is still in effect) (uncommon, Southlands and Highlands)

***Sylas Petals**: the petals from this silver mountain flower help with frostbite and cold, give a +2 to Saving Throws vs. Natural, but cause temporary blindness for about an hour (rare, Weatherpeaks)

***Telks Bark**: the bark from this scrubby bush, if injested, suppresses infravision for 24 hours. Tastes like anais (uncommon, found in the Lowlands).

***Thurl Cloves**: crushing these cloves and drinking them with water yields instant healing of 1HP per clove (common, found in the Southlands and Lowlands)

***Vishit Grass**: this thistly grass can be eaten (best if boiled) to resist the onset of lycanthropy. It can also be used to help prevent lycanthropy infection (uncommon, Lowlands and the Fold)

**White Bryony**: (plant) this plant provides good fortune for the people living next to it, but if destroyed or dug up will curse them with unhappiness (rare, Grasslands)

**Windclamit** (fruit): boiling and eating this reddish orange fruit yields 3d10 HP of instant healing (very rare, from the Grasslands)

**Zaten Flower**: this beautiful purple flower, if ingested, permanently ages you d10 years, and for 2d6 days covers you in pussy boils and oozing rashes (Comeliness -d12+2) (very rare, Grasslands and Borderlands)

*The original (and much longer) list evolved over the years, taken in part from the 1st ed DMG as well as Dragon Magazine articles and Thieves' World ("Alten Stulwig's Grimoire" or something to that effect) along with some of our own imaginings.*

# A Few Magic Items

(from the Field Guide section on Magic)

*This is a quick list of well-known magic items, the kind in use around the Lowlands, known to any adventurer worth their salt.*

**Hot Pipes**: dwarven pipes that light themselves once you tamp some decent tobacco into them and take a nice tug

**Garron Masts**: mastheads on ships that ward off bad luck and sorcery

**Elf Shot**: small stones that can bring sudden illness or death if they strike you, but also used to ward of bad spirits and illness if worn (from the faie, not actually related to elves)

**Cold Iron**: used to ward off or injure faieries; 'cold iron' refers to raw and little-worked iron

**True Silver**: used to ward off or kill werewolves

**Spirit Lamps**: gas lamps that (supposedly) never lose their flame

**Sight Stones**: crystals and other opaque stones with the ability to show the true form and nature of things when used like a lense

**Dwarf Dust**: a flour-like powder that once sprinkled will (supposedly) reveal hidden or invisible people who walk through (lasts for months)

**Dragon Lace**: silk garters from Khitagan that increase the beauty of the wearer

**Holy Symbols**: for the superstitious lot, but are supposed to ward off curses and demons and bring good luck

**Red Salt**: dwarven bath salts that prevent common illnesses; the salts are red but the water stays clear

**Red Smoke**: dwarven incense that creates a germ-killing smoke, smells a little like lavender

**Bug Stones**: smooth river rocks that keep bugs and mosquitos away, usually carried on a person

**Ice Bricks**: dwarven bricks that stay cold for years, used in larders

**Dwarf Meat**: a bland high-protein fungus harvested by the dwarves and mixed into meals (think tofu)

**Gotzhands**: prosthetic limbs made by the dwarves, usually made of metal